CELPIP EXPRESS

Reading Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 12

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

Read the following message.

Attention: Simon Theroux

I'm writing regarding a recent incident involving the City of Montreal. On January 3rd, after filling up my car, I returned to my residence around 10:30 p.m. and inadvertently parked near an orange "No Parking" sign. It was quite hard to see this sign as it was covered in blowing snow. I carried one bag of groceries to my apartment and when I came back for the second bag, I discovered that my unlocked vehicle was gone.

I checked your website and it said that cars were being towed to a lot at the end of Henri-Bourassa Street to make way for snow removal trucks. The next day, I took a $3 bus ride to the stated address, but my car was not there. I called the City and Customer Service Representative Viviane Belanger was able to finally solve the mystery. It turned out that it had been necessary to establish a secondary lot in order to accommodate all of the cars that needed to be towed. Unfortunately the website had not been updated to include the second address. Thus, visitors to the website only saw information related to the primary lot.

Once I obtained the address of the secondary lot, I set off to find my car. It was snowing again and -32°C. I waited for over half an hour for another bus, paid the driver another $3, and headed two kilometres in the opposite direction. Twenty minutes later, I found my car at the other address, its wheels stuck in snow, its exterior covered with grime, and its windshield displaying a $115 towing bill. To make matters worse, someone managed to steal $80 worth of my gasoline, presumably by siphoning it out of the fuel tank.

The fine is due tomorrow. I've tried repeatedly to pay it online but always receive a message saying the information hasn't been entered into your system. I don't dispute the charges, but I just want to confirm that I should pay the invoice in spite of the mistakes made by the City.

Sincerely,

Fatima Djaout

Choose the **best** option according to the information given in the message.

1. Fatima's purpose in writing is _____
- ◯ to explain a late payment.
- ◯ to make an apology.
- ◯ to claim compensation.
- ◯ to seek clarification.

2. Simon Theroux works _____
- ◯ in the city government.
- ◯ at a towing company.
- ◯ at a collection agency.
- ◯ at a police station.

3. The wrong information was provided by _____
- ◯ the customer service representative.
- ◯ the recipient of the letter.
- ◯ the municipal government.
- ◯ the bus driver.

4. The car disappeared because it was _____
- ◯ blocking a city-owned vehicle.
- ◯ in an unpaid parking spot.
- ◯ stuck in snow with no gas.
- ◯ easy for thieves to steal.

5. Fatima's vehicle was _____
- ◯ black.
- ◯ empty.
- ◯ dirty.
- ◯ stolen.

6. The mistake involved a misreported _____
- ◯ location.
- ◯ time.
- ◯ sign.
- ◯ fee.

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

Here is a response to the message. Complete the response by filling in the blanks.

Dear Ms. Djaout,

Thank you for your message. I can understand how
7. _____ the situation must be for you. To answer your question, I'm afraid you will still have to 8. _____ despite the problems you have experienced. We have had several users report issues related to payment of fines via our website. The need for additional snow removal services has led to an increase in the number of 9. _____ and this in turn has put pressure on our data entry systems. We expect these problems to be resolved by 10. _____ We are granting 11. _____ for all outstanding tickets until then.
Cordially,

Simon Theroux

7. ◯ odd
◯ interesting
◯ frustrating
◯ satisfying

8. ◯ take the bus
◯ find your car
◯ pay the fine
◯ check the website

9. ◯ cars being towed
◯ visitors to the city of Montreal
◯ unlocked vehicles
◯ bus passengers

10. ◯ warmer temperatures and less snowfall.
◯ the end of this week.
◯ our customer service representatives.
◯ the time you locate your car.

11. ◯ excuses
◯ extensions
◯ permission
◯ wishes

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PART 2

Halifax Garden Hotel

1980 Robie St
Halifax, NS

Our review — Customer's reviews (21)

From:
~~CAD 169~~ CAD 144
avg. per night

Located by Halifax Common in downtown Halifax. The Halifax Garden Hotel is a full amenity hotel ideal both for business travel and vacations.

The Brooke Suites

1515 South Park St
Halifax, NS

Our review — Customer's reviews (15)

From:
CAD 208
avg. per night

This full service, grand hotel has 260 completely upgraded and finely appointed guestrooms and suites, complete with every modern convenience.

The Affordable Inn

560 Bedford Hwy
Halifax, NS

Our review — Customer's reviews (8)

From:
CAD 129
avg. per night

This affordable and clean hotel is located on Bedford Basin, six kilometres from downtown. Pets welcome. Microwave in room.

The Thunderbird Suites

1496 Hollis St
Halifax, NS

Our review — Customer's reviews (12)

From:
CAD 154
avg. per night

This is a newly constructed downtown hotel. Full amenities are provided including a gym and room service.

Read the following email message about the diagram on the left. Complete the email by filling in the blanks

Subject: Halifax Hotels
To: Mary Kaczinski <kaczinski@lightmail.bc.ca>
From: Beth Middleton <b.middleton@sterlings.ca>

Hi Mary,

I went online and found a few options for our three-night stay in Halifax. The cheapest is The Affordable Inn. It's 1. _____ There's no restaurant or room service. But really, why would we even consider The Affordable Inn when 2. _____ is only a little more expensive, right downtown, and only opened this year. Then again, the 3. _____ is probably the most luxurious. It's certainly got a luxury price tag (for Halifax anyway). The website gave it the highest rating of the four hotels listed, which is probably a good sign.

Note that all the listed hotels have 4. _____ and also internet. Funnily enough, The Brooke Suites doesn't
5. _____ but I can hardly imagine you'll miss that too much when visiting Halifax in the winter.

Let me know what you think.
Beth

1. ◯ very basic.
   ◯ in the city centre.
   ◯ got a great rating.
   ◯ just been renovated.

2. ◯ The Brooke Suites
   ◯ Halifax Garden Hotel
   ◯ The Affordable Inn
   ◯ The Thunderbird Suites

3. ◯ The Brooke Suites
   ◯ Halifax Garden Hotel
   ◯ The Affordable Inn
   ◯ The Thunderbird Suites

4. ◯ a restaurant
   ◯ a fitness centre
   ◯ room service
   ◯ wheelchair access

5. ◯ have a swimming pool,
   ◯ allow pets in the rooms,
   ◯ have a fitness room,
   ◯ serve food in the hotel,

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PART 2

Choose the best option.

6. Beth is _____

- ◯ selling a hotel package to Mary.
- ◯ arranging for Mary to visit her.
- ◯ planning a trip with Mary.
- ◯ planning to visit Mary in Halifax.

7. Beth seems to prefer a hotel that _____

- ◯ is as cheap as possible.
- ◯ is fairly comfortable.
- ◯ has a swimming pool.
- ◯ allows pets in the rooms.

8. Beth thinks that the website ratings are _____

- ◯ quite misleading
- ◯ somewhat helpful.
- ◯ very unreliable.
- ◯ very accurate.

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PART 3

Read the following passage.

A. As crude oil becomes scarcer and high gasoline prices threaten the world economy, it is clear that alternative energy sources must be found soon. The best alternatives to petroleum would be renewable forms of energy that are sustainable and cause less pollution. One such alternative is biodiesel fuel made from plant and animal material. This idea is not a new one: In 1893, a German engineer, Rudolph Diesel, invented an engine that ran on peanut oil and other plant oils, but by the 1920s the abundance of inexpensive petroleum meant that gasoline soon became the main source of energy for cars and trucks.

B. Today, biodiesel fuel can be made from a wide variety of easily renewable plants such as soybeans and canola. It can even be made from waste vegetable oil and animal fats. Biodiesel engines produce much less pollution than gasoline engines, and, fortunately, engines designed for gas consumption need only minor modifications to run on biodiesel fuel. This feature of biodiesel is important when weighing its merits against other options such as hydrogen fuel cells. These other options, though less polluting than biodiesel, are nonetheless based on technology that is still some years away from general use.

C. Despite their benefits, biodiesel fuels can be expensive to produce and can still negatively impact the environment. To be economically viable, biodiesel fuels have to produce more energy than is required to make them, but energy—petroleum-based energy, in fact—is needed to grow the crops these fuels are made from and to produce the fuel itself. Moreover, petroleum-based fertilizers and pesticides are still used in producing these plants. Another drawback is the shortage of land available in the world to grow food, let alone crops for fuel. This last problem, however, may be solved by making biofuel from algea. This green plant produces more energy than other plants and can be grown in areas unsuitable for food production.

D. Currently, low consumer demand for biodiesel fuel makes it both more expensive to produce and less available than gasoline. However, as the growing scarcity of crude oil drives gasoline prices higher, the demand for biodiesel fuel will likely increase. The price of gasoline could rise even higher if the costs of its impact on the environment and public health are taken into account. Biodiesel has yet to become the fuel of choice, but it may be in the near future.

E. Not given in any of the above paragraphs.

Decide which paragraph, A to D, has the information given in each statement below.
Select E if the information is not given in any of the paragraphs.

1. It's relatively easy to convert traditional vehicles to biodiesel fuelled vehicles.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

2. Biodiesel fuel's profitability will depend on how efficiently it can be made.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

3. The development of fuel derived from plants is limited by market forces.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

4. Farmers may replace their food crops with fuel crops to maximize revenue.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

5. One disadvantage of biodiesel fuel is its doubtful cost-effectiveness.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

6. Biodiesel fuel may become more feasible as crude oil supplies diminish.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

7. Early biodiesel fuels were replaced by cheaper fuels.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

8. Biodiesel fuel will reduce our dependency on foreign fuel sources.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

9. Ecologically friendly alternatives to biofuel are forthcoming.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

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PART 4

Read the following article from a website.

Live-in Caregiver Amy Mercado is concerned that current policy reforms in the Canadian Temporary Foreign Worker Program are simply band-aid solutions to bigger issues. The program allows Canadian families to hire foreign workers to live temporarily in their homes and care for elderly, young, or disabled citizens. The program is one of three ways that immigrants can acquire permanent Canadian residency. Originally trained as a nurse, Mercado came to Canada from the Philippines 13 years ago to work as a live-in caregiver. She is now a Canadian citizen. Suffering verbal harassment in the first few years of her employment, she's only too aware of how often live-in caregivers face unsafe working standards. "Although foreign live-in caregivers are technically under the same labour laws as Canadian workers, they work and live in someone else's private home," Mercado explains. "They can suffer a lot of unseen damage."

Ministry Official Mark Swanson says that while the program is nowhere near perfect, they're trying their best to reform it. "Recent protections, such as the implementation of a standardized employment contract between caregivers and families and a phone help line for caregivers, have made a big difference," Swanson says. One of the major changes was allowing caregivers to apply for open work permits while waiting for residency. However, the program is currently backlogged with about 80,000 applicants, and wait times can be up to 38 months.

Mercado says policy changes are helpful, but are not enough. One of the greatest challenges that caregivers face is having to leave their own children and families behind in their home country. The wait time for residency means they are separated for several years. "It's sad and ironic, I took care of other people's children for 3 years while I was separated from my own," Mercado says. "Family reunification needs to be made the top priority for policy reform."

Although the Live-in Caregiver Program needs to be reformed, it appears what's subsequently needed is federal investment in childcare and old-age programs. Foreign supply of labour is a mere band-aid solution to Canada's lack of funding for such programs.

Choose the **best** option according to the information given on the website.

1. Mercado would probably agree that _____

- ◯ caregivers should be paid more.
- ◯ caregivers are lucky to have jobs.
- ◯ caregivers should live with their families.
- ◯ caregivers should translate their contracts.

2. In addition to the current reform plan, Mercado would probably want _____

- ◯ a more efficient process for residency.
- ◯ better protection against employer abuse.
- ◯ quicker ways of bringing her family to Canada.
- ◯ an ability to change caregiver jobs.

3. The Temporary Foreign Worker Program is popular because_____

- ◯ it requires the immigrant to have a job.
- ◯ it allows immigrants to work at a variety of jobs.
- ◯ it speeds up citizenship application.
- ◯ it provides an opportunity to apply for residency.

4. According to Swanson, the Temporary Foreign Worker Program _____

- ◯ is undergoing successful reform.
- ◯ is no longer a government priority.
- ◯ requires many more reforms to be effective.
- ◯ will have reduced wait times in the near future.

5. The author of the article thinks that a bigger need than these policy reforms is _____

- ◯ better budgeting for senior-care programs.
- ◯ better schooling in childcare programs.
- ◯ improved protection against harassment.
- ◯ quicker availability of open work permits.

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PART 4

The following is a comment by a visitor to the website page. Complete the comment by choosing the best option to fill in each blank.

After reading today's article, I was shocked to learn that 6. _____ This has been reported for many years. Why is it still happening? Caregivers should be able to 7. _____ just like anyone else. Caregivers should receive fair pay and be protected by 8. _____ How can help lines work? If a caregiver is being harassed, a chat on the helpline 9. _____ How are the open work permits going to help? By the time caregivers are allowed to change jobs, perhaps 10. _____ Considering everything, I think caregivers must be admired for their hard-work and dedication.

6. ◯ abuse still happens to caregivers.
   ◯ caregivers are still living with families.
   ◯ the government isn't supporting caregivers.
   ◯ caregivers can't change jobs.

7. ◯ complain about their workplace conditions,
   ◯ complain to their employers,
   ◯ visit with their families and friends,
   ◯ take vacations to visit family,

8. ◯ their contracts.
   ◯ the local police.
   ◯ the labour laws.
   ◯ their employers.

9. ◯ won't solve the problem.
   ◯ will alert the police.
   ◯ won't change the family.
   ◯ will increase the problems.

10. ◯ another caregiver position will not be available .
    ◯ they will want to leave Canada.
    ◯ the wait for work permits may be even longer.
    ◯ they can get jobs as nurses.

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Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	to seek clarification.
Question 2	in the city government.
Question 3	the municipal government.
Question 4	blocking a city-owned vehicle.
Question 5	dirty.
Question 6	location.
Question 7	frustrating
Question 8	pay the fine
Question 9	cars being towed
Question 10	the end of this week.
Question 11	extensions

PART 2	
Question 1	very basic.
Question 2	The Thunderbird Suites
Question 3	The Brooke Suites
Question 4	a fitness centre
Question 5	have a swimming pool,
Question 6	planning a trip with Mary.
Question 7	is fairly comfortable.
Question 8	somewhat helpful.

PART 3	
Question 1	B
Question 2	C
Question 3	D
Question 4	E
Question 5	C
Question 6	D
Question 7	A
Question 8	E
Question 9	B

PART 4	
Question 1	caregivers should live with their families.
Question 2	quicker ways of bringing her family to Canada.
Question 3	it provides an opportunity to apply for residency.
Question 4	is undergoing successful reform.
Question 5	better budgeting for senior-care programs.
Question 6	abuse still happens to caregivers.
Question 7	complain about their workplace conditions,
Question 8	the labour laws.
Question 9	won't solve the problem.
Question 10	they will want to leave Canada.

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